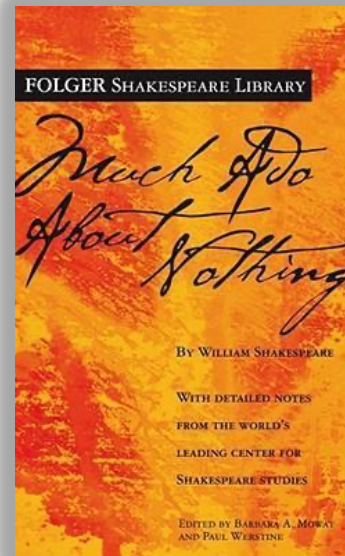
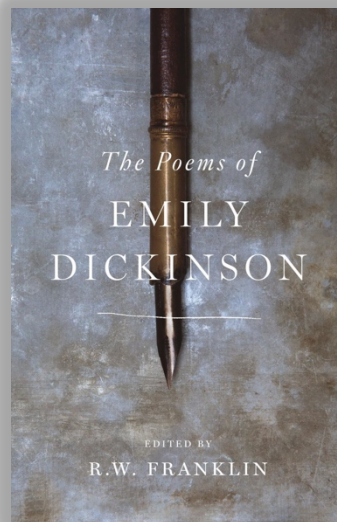
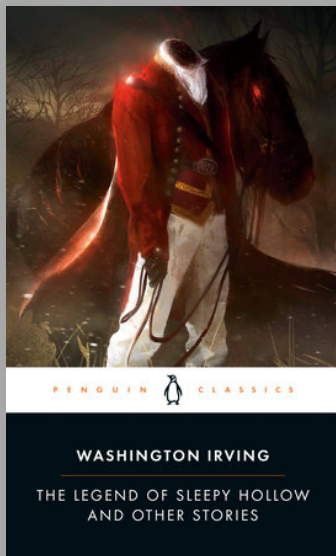




UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Literary Criticism

State • 2025



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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • State • 2025

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History

30 items (1 point each)

1. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the
 - A) aubade.
 - B) elegy.
 - C) hymn.
 - D) limerick.
 - E) ode.
2. The Japanese-born British author of *The Remains of the Day*, *The Unconsoled*, and *A Pale View of Hills*, among other award-winning novels, and the recipient of the 2017 Nobel Prize for Literature is
 - A) Kazuo Ishiguro.
 - B) Yasunari Kawabata.
 - C) Imre Kertész.
 - D) Kenzaburō Ōe.
 - E) Gao Xingjian.
3. The form of understatement in which a thing is affirmed by stating the negative of its opposite is
 - A) antithesis.
 - B) hyperbole.
 - C) litotes.
 - D) neologism.
 - E) paradox.
4. The recipient of the 2012 T. S. Eliot Prize and the 2013 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her *Stag's Leap* is
 - A) Rae Armantrout.
 - B) Claudia Emerson.
 - C) Louise Glück.
 - D) Tyehimba Jess.
 - E) Sharon Olds.
5. One of the terms for an elaborate comparison that differs from an ordinary comparison, i.e., a simile, in being more ornate and involved, the vehicle being developed into an independent aesthetic object that for the moment upstages the tenor, is a
 - A) conceit.
 - B) controlling image.
 - C) diminishing metaphor.
 - D) Homeric simile.
 - E) transferred epithet.
6. The label applied to certain, principally, North Carolinian writers, including Robert Creeley, who were highly influential in the projective verse movement, is the
 - A) Black Mountain School.
 - B) Frankfurt School.
 - C) Harlem Renaissance.
 - D) Kailyard School.
 - E) Satanic School.
7. **Not** a group of writers, poets, and playwrights, as well as other cultural figures whose contributions represent either regional or national interests or trends of the United States in some way, is the
 - A) Agrarians.
 - B) Hartford Wits.
 - C) Muckrakers.
 - D) Parnassians.
 - E) Transcendentalists.
8. The nineteenth-century author of *Middlemarch*, *The Mill on the Floss*, *Silas Marner*, and *Adam Bede*, is
 - A) Charles Dickens.
 - B) George Eliot.
 - C) John Stuart Mill.
 - D) William Makepeace Thackeray.
 - E) Anthony Trollope.
9. Notably boring material that takes up time and space without advancing the plot or explaining a character is
 - A) a chrestomathy.
 - B) a gazebo.
 - C) a miscellany.
 - D) an omnibus.
 - E) a pastiche.
10. The form of comedy characterized by ridiculous exaggeration and distortion, wherein the sublime may be made absurd; honest emotion may be turned to sentimentality; a serious subject may be treated frivolously or a frivolous subject seriously is the
 - A) burlesque.
 - B) lampoon.
 - C) parody.
 - D) prolegomenon.
 - E) travesty.

11. The quotation that appears on the title page of a book or as, for instance, a motto heading a section of a work is an
 - A) epigone.
 - B) epigram.
 - C) epigraph.
 - D) epitaph.
 - E) epithet.
12. The twentieth-century American author of *Light in August*, *As I Lay Dying*, *Absalom, Absalom*, *The Sound and the Fury*, and *The Reivers* is
 - A) James Baldwin.
 - B) William Faulkner.
 - C) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
 - D) Ernest Hemingway.
 - E) John Steinbeck.
13. The name by which the early nineteenth-century English Romantics of Cumbria and Lancashire—William Wordsworth, Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Robert Southey, Dorothy Wordsworth, Charles Lamb, Mary Lamb, Sara Coleridge, and Thomas De Quincey—came to be known is the
 - A) Cockney School.
 - B) Imagists.
 - C) Lake School.
 - D) Pre-Raphaelites.
 - E) Scriblerus Club.
14. **Not** one of the several denigrating, derogatory, or unflatteringly descriptive names assigned to a collective of poets or authors by that group's contemporaries is
 - A) Fleshly School.
 - B) Martian School.
 - C) Muckrakers.
 - D) Satanic School.
 - E) Spasmodics.
15. The basic principles of dramatic structure involving action, time, and place attributed to Aristotle (though he addresses only the principle of action) are known collectively as the
 - A) Five Points.
 - B) Four Ages.
 - C) Great Chain of Being.
 - D) Seven Cardinal Virtues.
 - E) Three Unities.
16. A lyric poem that is about dawn or that serves as a morning serenade and whose tone is usually joyous is called a(n)
 - A) aubade.
 - B) *ballade*.
 - C) dirge.
 - D) lament.
 - E) paeon.
17. The recipient of the 2021 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for his "deeply felt consideration of Black masculinity and how it is perceived," is
 - A) David Auburn.
 - B) Nilo Cruz.
 - C) Stephen Adly Guirgis.
 - D) Katori Hall.
 - E) Michael R. Jackson.
18. The term used for modern tragedies that do not conform to the traditions or aims of classical tragedy from which it differs in a greater freedom of technique, wider scope of theme and treatment, greater emphasis on character, looser structure, among other aspects of dramatic conventions is
 - A) classical tragedy.
 - B) domestic tragedy.
 - C) revenge tragedy.
 - D) romantic tragedy.
 - E) tragicomedy.
19. The twentieth-century novelist who wrote *The Intuitionist*, *The Underground Railroad*, *The Nickel Boys* and received both the 2017 and the 2020 Pulitzer Prizes for Fiction is
 - A) John Cheever.
 - B) Joshua Cohen.
 - C) Cormac McCarthy.
 - D) Philip Roth.
 - E) Colson Whitehead.
20. Specifically, an address to a deity asking for aid, including, especially, the convention characterizing the epic in which assistance in composing the epic is requested of a muse, is (a/an)
 - A) apostrophe.
 - B) *deus ex machina*.
 - C) harangue.
 - D) invocation.
 - E) rhetorical accent.

21. The stock character in drama who first appeared in the ancient world in Greek comedy and starred in Roman comedy, in Renaissance theater, and then well into recent literature and film as the braggart soldier is the
 - A) Byronic hero.
 - B) doppelgänger.
 - C) ingénue.
 - D) miles gloriosus.
 - E) tritagonist.
22. A narrative form located somewhere between authentic history and intentional fiction having the characteristics of Icelandic medieval heroic adventures is known as a(n)
 - A) epic.
 - B) fabliau.
 - C) legend.
 - D) romance.
 - E) saga.
23. The twentieth-century Irish author and philosopher who wrote *A Severed Head*, *Nuns and Soldiers*, *The Nice and the Good*, and *The Black Prince*, is
 - A) Elizabeth Bowen.
 - B) Molly Keane.
 - C) Iris Murdoch.
 - D) Edna O'Brien.
 - E) Dolores O'Riordan.
24. **Not** a work of literature directly associated with the Anglo-Saxon Period in English literary and cultural history is
 - A) *The Battle of Maldon*.
 - B) *Beowulf*.
 - C) *The Canterbury Tales*.
 - D) *An Ecclesiastical History of the English People*.
 - E) "The Seafarer."
25. Authors, including James Fenimore Cooper, Bret Harte, Mark Twain, Hamlin Garland, Larry McMurry, and Cormac McCarthy, whose writings address life in the United States during westward expansion are contributors to the genre known as
 - A) diasporic literature.
 - B) Frontier Literature.
 - C) metafiction.
 - D) Native American Literature.
 - E) Popular Literature.
26. The eponymic term for an expression, often involving a pun, that gives a literal sense to a figurative statement, such as "'Simply remarkable,' said the teacher when asked her opinion about the new dry-erase board," is
 - A) gongorism.
 - B) malapropism.
 - C) marinism.
 - D) spoonerism.
 - E) wellerism.
27. The term applied to the work of a group of modern poets whose work, often addressing the audience directly, features a public and sometimes painful display of private, personal matters is
 - A) confessional poetry.
 - B) didactic poetry.
 - C) patter song.
 - D) popular literature.
 - E) Sapphic verse.
28. **Not** among the many literary terms describing complimentary repetition of sounds appearing as end rhyme without an exact vocalic correspondence
 - A) analyzed rhyme.
 - B) assonant rhyme.
 - C) broken rhyme.
 - D) near rhyme.
 - E) slant rhyme.
29. Brief verses—often anonymous and traditional—with percussive rhythm, heavy rhyme, and written for young children are known collectively as
 - A) clerihevs.
 - B) envoys.
 - C) limericks.
 - D) nursery rhymes.
 - E) virelays.
30. Essentially a misnomer, an alternative term for feminine rhyme, a rhyme in which both the stressed syllable and the following unstressed syllable of one line-ending word rhymes, syllable for syllable, with the next line-ending word is
 - A) compound rhyme.
 - B) double rhyme.
 - C) leonine rhyme.
 - D) mosaic rhyme.
 - E) unmasculine rhyme.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List

20 items (2 points each)

Items 31-36 are associated with William Shakespeare's *Much Ado about Nothing*.

Items 37-41 are associated with Washington Irving's *"Sleepy Hollow" and Other Stories*.

Items 42-50 are associated with Emily Dickinson's selected poetry.

31. In Shakespeare's *Much Ado about Nothing*, the self-assessment "I cannot be said to be a flattering honest man, it must not be denied but I am a plain-dealing villain" is delivered by
 - A) Balthasar.
 - B) Benedick.
 - C) Claudio.
 - D) Dogberry.
 - E) Don John.
32. The Messenger's report, "He hath borne himself beyond the promise of his age, doing in the figure of a lamb the feats of a lion. He hath indeed better bettered expectation than you must expect of me to tell you how" is an appraisal of
 - A) Balthasar.
 - B) Benedick.
 - C) Claudio.
 - D) Dogberry.
 - E) Don John.
33. Dogberry's exclamation, "O, villain! Thou wilt be condemned into everlasting redemption for this," is but one example of his many character-defining
 - A) byronisms.
 - B) euphemisms.
 - C) grundyisms.
 - D) malapropisms.
 - E) spoonerisms.
34. Benedick's "Leander the good swimmer, Troilus the first employer of panders [. . .]" constitutes a
 - A) biblical allusion.
 - B) classical allusion.
 - C) historical allusion.
 - D) sports allusion.
 - E) topical allusion.
35. "An he had been a dog that should have howled thus, they would have hanged him [. . .]. I had as lief have heard the night raven, come what plague could have come after it" comprises, as an aside,
 - A) Benedick's response to Balthasar's singing.
 - B) Dogberry's remembering his night watch.
 - C) Hero's reaction to Claudio's public accusation.
 - D) Margaret's tolerance of Borachio's attention.
 - E) Ursula's recounting Dogberry's accusation.
36. The exchange among Don Pedro, Claudio, and Benedick, "I have the toothache." // "Draw it." // "Hang it!" // "You must hang it first, and draw it afterwards," is a witty topical reference to (a/the)
 - A) consequences of eavesdropping.
 - B) contemporary mode of execution.
 - C) Elizabethan odontological methods.
 - D) Italian odontological methods.
 - E) medieval word game called Drawman and Hangman.
37. Irving's narrator in "Traits of Indian Character" opines, "It is honorable, because it is in fact the triumph of lofty sentiment over an instinctive repugnance to pain, and over those yearnings after personal ease and security, which society has condemned as ignoble," a reference to
 - A) British imperialism.
 - B) Manifest Destiny.
 - C) scalping colonists.
 - D) specific Indigenous cultural traditions.
 - E) Western European chivalrous courage.
38. "[P]ersecuted while living, slandered and dishonored when dead" serves as the summative closing to the "scanty story" of
 - A) Ichabod Crane.
 - B) Metacomet.
 - C) William Roscoe.
 - D) William Shakespeare.
 - E) Rip Van Winkle.
39. Rip Van Winkle learns of the presumed details of his disappearance from
 - A) Jonathan Dolittle.
 - B) Brom Dutcher.
 - C) Judith Gardenier.
 - D) Diedrich Knickerbocker.
 - E) Nicholas Vedder.
40. "His idea pervades the place: the whole pile seems but as his mausoleum. [. . .]. [O]ther traces of him may be false or dubious, but here is palpable evidence and absolute certainty" is the narrator's reflection on (a/the)
 - A) book in the Stratford-on-Avon museum library.
 - B) Folger Library Series.
 - C) Globe Theatre.
 - D) Stratford-on-Avon cemetery.
 - E) Westminster Abbey.

41. The comparison (herein akin to the epic simile), "Few guests sit down to a varied table with an equal appetite for every dish. [. . .] Thus each [dish] is condemned in its turn; and yet, amidst this variety of appetites, seldom does a dish go away from the table without being tasted and relished by some one or other of the guests," constitutes a controlling image in Irving's

- A) "Christmas Day."
- B) "Christmas Eve."
- C) "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow."
- D) "L'Envoy."
- E) "The Stage Coach."

Items 42-44 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[A narrow Fellow in the Grass]

A narrow Fellow in the Grass
Occasionally rides—
You may have met him? Did you not
His notice instant is— 4

The Grass divides as with a Comb—
A spotted Shaft is seen,
And then it closes at your Feet
And opens further on— 8

He likes a Boggy Acre—
A Floor too cool for Corn—
Yet when a Boy and Barefoot
I more than once at Noon 12

Have passed I thought a Whip Lash
Unbraiding in the Sun
When stooping to secure it
It wrinkled And was gone— 16

Several of Nature's People
I know and they know me
I feel for them a transport
Of Cordiality 20

But never met this Fellow
Attended or alone
Without a tighter Breathing
And Zero at the Bone. 24

42. The imagery of Dickinson's "[A Narrow fellow in the Grass]" is primarily

- A) auditory.
- B) gustatory.
- C) olfactory.
- D) tactile.
- E) visual.

43. The onomatopoeic quality of the entirety of line 4 relies, in part, on

- A) assonance.
- B) consonance.
- C) dissonance.
- D) resonance.
- E) sigmatism.

44. Lines 13-14 visual imagery's being centered on the onomatopoeic "whip-lash" is a nuanced form of

- A) chiaroscuro.
- B) metonymy.
- C) synaesthesia.
- D) synecdoche.
- E) zeugma.

Items 45-48 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[I felt a Funeral, in my Brain]

I felt a Funeral, in my Brain,
And Mourners to and fro
Kept treading—treading—till it seemed
That Sense was breaking through— 4

And when they all were seated,
A Service, like a Drum—
Kept beating—beating—till I thought
My mind was going numb— 8

And then I heard them lift a Box
And creak across my Soul
With those same Boots of Lead, again,
Then Space—began to toll, 12

As all the Heavens were a Bell,
And Being, but an Ear,
And I, and Silence, some strange Race
Wrecked, solitary, here— 16

And then a Plank in Reason, broke,
And I dropped down, and down—
And hit a World, at every plunge,
And Finished knowing—then— 20

45. The stanza form of Emily Dickinson's "[I felt a Funeral, in my Brain]" is the

- A) ballad stanza.
- B) envelope stanza.
- C) heroic stanza.
- D) hymnal stanza.
- E) Pushkin stanza.

46. The imagery of Dickinson's "[I felt a Funeral, in my Brain]" is primarily

- A) auditory.
- B) gustatory.
- C) olfactory.
- D) tactile.
- E) visual.

47. The tone of Dickinson's "[I felt a Funeral . . .]" is

- A) fitfully amused.
- B) introspectively discordant.
- C) painfully apathetic.
- D) paradoxically noisy and silent.
- E) resignedly fearful.

48. The poem's thematic concerns focus on (a/the)

- A) death and a species of madness.
- B) funereal sounds of drums, bells, and planks.
- C) mind going numb.
- D) not fearing mourners at funerals.
- E) starting verse lines with monosyllabic words.

Items 49-50 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[There is a flower that Bees prefer—]

There is a flower that Bees prefer—
And Butterflies—desire—
To gain the Purple Democrat
The Humming Bird—aspire— 4

And Whatsoever Insect pass—
A Honey bear away
Proportioned to his several dearth
And her—capacity— 8

Her face be rounder than the Moon
And ruddier than the Gown
Of Orchis in the Pasture—
Or Rhododendron—worn— 12

She doth not wait for June—
Before the World be Green—
Her sturdy little Countenance
Against the Wind—be seen— 16

Contending with the Grass—
Near Kinsman to Herself—
For privilege of Sod and Sun—
Sweet Litigants for Life— 20

And when the Hills be full—
And newer fashions blow—
Doth not retract a single spice
For pang of jealousy— 24

Her Public—be the Noon—
Her Providence—the Sun—
Her Progress—by the Bee—proclaimed—
In sovereign—Swerveless Tune— 28

The Bravest—of the Host—
Surrendering—the last—
Nor even of Defeat—aware—
When cancelled by the Frost— 32

49. The continuation of grammar and meaning from one stanza to the next is known as

- A) end-stopped line.
- B) enjambment.
- C) reduplication.
- D) run-on line.
- E) truncation.

50. The operative word *Democrat* (line 3) suggests the

- A) beauty at one end of the color spectrum.
- B) hierarchy of needs from bees to hummingbirds.
- C) political aspiration among hummingbirds.
- D) ready availability for the various pollinators.
- E) struggle of the amphimacer for recognition.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism

15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-52 refer to the following verse

Did Descartes
Depart
With the thought
"Therefore, I'm not"?

51. The verse form that these four rhyming lines are an example of is the

- A) cleriheuw.
- B) doggerel.
- C) echo verse.
- D) lampoon.
- E) limerick.

52. The species of rhyme characterizing the first two lines in this four-line verse is

- A) broken.
- B) heteromorous.
- C) leonine.
- D) macaronic.
- E) slant.

Items 53-59 refer to Edmund Spenser's

Sonnet LXXV
from *Amoretti*

One day I wrote her name upon the strand,
But came the waves and washed it away:
Again I wrote it with a second hand,
But came the tide, and made my pains his prey. 4
"Vain man," said she, "that dost in vain assay,
A mortal thing so to immortalize;
For I myself shall like to this decay,
And eke my name be wiped out likewise." 8
"Not so," (quod I) "let baser things devise
To die in dust, but you shall live by fame:
My verse your vertues rare shall eternize,
And in the heavens write your glorious name: 12
Where whenas death shall all the world subdue,
Our love shall live, and later life renew."

53. Edmund Spenser's Sonnet LXXV from his sonnet sequence entitled *Amoretti* is an example of the
- A) Hopkins's curtal sonnet.
 - B) Miltonic sonnet.
 - C) Petrarchan sonnet.
 - D) Shakespearean sonnet.
 - E) Spenserian sonnet.
54. The placing of sentence elements to accommodate both the metric pattern and the rhyme, as found in lines 2 and 11, especially, is called
- A) enjambment.
 - B) hiatus.
 - C) inversion.
 - D) redaction.
 - E) truncation.

55. The sonnet's turn in thought occurs in
- A) line 2.
 - B) line 4.
 - C) line 9.
 - D) line 10.
 - E) line 13.
56. The tension characterizing the subject of the poem finds organization in
- A) analogue.
 - B) dialogue.
 - C) epilogue.
 - D) monologue.
 - E) parologue.

57. The poem's repetition of initial phonemes in close proximity, as found throughout the sonnet, is

- A) alliteration.
- B) assonance.
- C) consonance.
- D) dissonance.
- E) resonance.

58. The melopoeic quality characterizing the vocalic repetition in lines 2, 4, 5, 7, and 8 of Spenser's Sonnet LXXV is

- A) alliteration.
- B) assonance.
- C) consonance.
- D) dissonance.
- E) resonance.

59. The inclusion of words in close proximity that share a common root, as found in line 14, is known as

- A) anaphora.
- B) epanalepsis.
- C) merism.
- D) polyptoton.
- E) symploce.

Items 60-61 refer to Spike Milligan's

A Silly Poem

Said Hamlet to Ophelia,
I'll draw a sketch of thee,
What kind of pencil shall I use?
2B or not 2B?

60. The form of Milligan's "A Silly Poem" is the

- A) common measure.
- B) englyn.
- C) long measure.
- D) Poulter's measure.
- E) short measure.

61. The wit, perhaps the declared "silliness," of Milligan's poem depends on a

- A) conceit.
- B) dead metaphor.
- C) pun.
- D) quibble.
- E) solecism.

Items 62-65 refer to A. E. Houseman's

To an Athlete Dying Young

The time you won your town the race
We chaired you through the market-place;
Man and boy stood cheering by,
And home we brought you shoulder-high. 4

Today, the road all runners come,
Shoulder-high we bring you home,
And set you at your threshold down,
Townsmen of a stiller town. 8

Smart lad, to slip betimes away
From fields where glory does not stay,
And early though the laurel* grows
It withers quicker than the rose. 12

Eyes the shady night has shut
Cannot see the record cut,
And silence sounds no worse than cheers
After earth has stopped the ears. 16

Now you will not swell the rout
Of lads that wore their honours out,
Runners whom renown outran
And the name died before the man. 20

So set, before its echoes fade,
The fleet foot on the sill* of shade,
And hold to the low lintel up
The still-defended challenge-cup. 24

And round that early-laurelled head
Will flock to gaze the strengthless dead,
And find unwithered on its curls
The garland briefer than a girl's. 28

* a tree whose leaves are worn in
recognition of success or victory

* horizontal piece of stone, wood,
or metal serving as a threshold

62. Line 22's imagery points directly to the poem's focus, as a secondary thematic concern, on
A) aesthetic distance.
B) kenosis.
C) liminality.
D) meliorism.
E) negative capability.
63. The speaker's addressing the athlete constitutes a(n)
A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) dramatic monologue.
D) reification.
E) soliloquy.
64. The repetition of the sibilant sounds that characterize line 15 is known as
A) assonance.
B) cacophony.
C) consonance.
D) resonance.
E) sigmatism.
65. The last line's meaning turns on (a/n)
A) conceit.
B) epiphany.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) simile.

Required Tie-Breaking Essay

on next page

Required Tie-Breaking Essay

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook's* notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway," and discuss the persona's characterization of the man viewing those who are viewing him, with special attention to line 19, "Nor did he lack for common entertainment."

The Figure in the Doorway

The grade surmounted, we were speeding high
Through level mountains nothing to the eye
But scrub oak, scrub oak and the lack of earth
That kept the oak from getting any girth.
But as through the monotony we ran, 5
We came to where there was a living man.
His great gaunt figure filled his cabin door,
And had he fallen inward on the floor,
He must have measured to the further wall.
But we who passed were not to see him fall. 10
The miles and miles he lived from anywhere
Were evidently something he could bear.
He stood unshaken, and if grim and gaunt,
It was not necessarily from want.
He had the oaks for heating and for light. 15
He had a hen, he had a pig, in sight.
He had a well, he had the rain to catch.
He had a ten by twenty garden patch.
Nor did he lack for common entertainment.
That I assume was what our passing train meant. 20
He could look at us in our diner eating,
And if so moved uncurl a hand in greeting.

Robert Frost

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UIL Literary Criticism
State • 2025

line arrows up ➔

1.	E	334
2.	A	
3.	C	275
4.	E	
5.	D	237
6.	A	59
7.	D	352
8.	B	565
9.	B	214
10.	A	69
11.	C	178
12.	B	576
13.	C	268
14.	B	286
15.	E	490
16.	A	45
17.	D	
18.	D	424
19.	E	
20.	D	257
21.	D	299
22.	E	426
23.	C	584
24.	C	523
25.	B	211
26.	E	501
27.	A	106
28.	C	68
29.	D	331
30.	B	152

31.	E	1.3.28
32.	C	1.1.13
33.	D	4.2.58
34.	B	5.2.30
35.	A	2.3.84
36.	B	3.2.21
37.	E	263
38.	B	281; 270; 365
39.	C	45
40.	D	244
41.	D	343
42.	E	
43.	E	
44.	C	469
45.	A	49
46.	A	
47.	B	
48.	A	
49.	B	174
50.	D	
51.	A	92
52.	D	282
53.	E	451
54.	C	257
55.	C	498
56.	B	139
57.	A	13
58.	B	43
59.	D	372
60.	A	101
61.	C	390
62.	C	273
63.	A	37
64.	E	
65.	E	445

FOLD

along the **three**
longitudinal
lines for ease
in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective
scores should not be altered to
reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1
are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2
are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3
are worth two points each.

DO NOT
mark (cross out)
actual **LETTER** answer;
mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer
to the *Handbook 12e*,

Folger-Simon & Schuster
Much Ado about Nothing,

Penguin Classics
*"The Legend of Sleepy
Hollow" and Other Stories*,

and
Belknap Press-HarvardUP
*The Poems of
Emily Dickinson*

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

- the degree to which the instructions have been followed,
- the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,
- the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and
- the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the speaker's characterization of both the "great gaunt figure" and "we who passed" him in Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway" include

- | | |
|------------------------|------------------|
| alliteration, | litotes, |
| anaphora, | masculine rhyme, |
| characterization, | repetition, |
| comparison (contrast), | round character, |
| couplet, | rhyme scheme, |
| feminine rhyme, | rhythm, |
| iambic pentameter, | theme, and |
| imagery, | tone. |
| irony, | |

Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway" is a fairly straightforward description of a recurring event (line 19 so implies), one that has given rise to a meditative reflection on what seems to be, in the final analysis, the superficial differences between someone in isolation and those who might, by virtue of traveling in company from one locus to another, consider themselves not bounded (or bound) by isolation.

The student should be able to draw—in summary—a description of the man in the doorway. The strong response, however, will note the round character developed through the speaker's observing the world beyond his doorway, being entertained by watching and, evidently, drawing his own conclusions about the lives of the people he sees framed by the windows of the train's passenger cars.

The young writer might recognize that the speaker is creating a vivid figure, one built on speculation—the train, no matter how many times it carries a passenger along the same track, offering but a glimpse of that figure in the doorway.

A stronger response to the essay prompt recognizes that much can be learned (perhaps ironically) about those on the train viewing the man in the doorway through the description of the man in the doorway himself. (Recall Faulkner's "Rose for Emily" and Chaucer's *General Prologue*, wherein we learn quite a bit about the narrators themselves through their descriptions of other characters).